Le Pen now presidential favorite

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【メール原文】

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summary

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Marine Le Pen is now the most likely winner of France’s 2027 presidential election, with profound consequences for French, European, and international politics.
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The 23 October debate could prove decisive for the Brazilian presidential race, with Senator Flavio Bolsonaro holding a slight edge over incumbent Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva.
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In China, the 21st Party Congress in late 2027 is very likely to grant Xi Jinping a fourth term as the general secretary of the Chinese Communist Party.
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On a client trip to China, Eurasia Group found that officials were prioritizing productive ties with the US, Canada, and the EU.
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Countries and sectors in this edition of the Daily Brief include the US, Brazil, China, France, Lebanon, and geo-economics.

the top line

France—Le Pen is now the basecase

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Domestic and international developments, combined with a volatile national mood, have made Marine Le Pen the most likely winner of the upcoming presidential election (a 40% probability, up from 35% previously), with profound consequences for French, European, and international politics.
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Centrist former Prime Minister Edouard Philippe remains the likely runner-up to Le Pen in the first round of the election on 18 April, but EG now places his odds of winning the second round on 2 May at 35% (down from 40% previously).
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Much could still happen to blunt Le Pen’s seemingly unstoppable march to the Elysee Palace, but while her victory is not inevitable, it is for now the most likely outcome.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: europe@eurasiagroup.net .

Brazil—Lula's late push trims Bolsonaro's odds to 60% from 70%

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EG has reduced Senator Flavio Bolsonaro’s odds of winning the presidential runoff to 60%, down from 70%, with President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva’s campaign making inroads in the last few days of campaigning.

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Adjusting for likely voters, Bolsonaro’s lead is probably 1-2 points, but could shrink further as an effective Workers’ Party campaign has shifted momentum towards Lula.

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The 23 October debate could prove decisive for the race’s outcome, though Bolsonaro will probably have a slight edge, and the two days remaining until the vote are unlikely to be enough for Lula to close a 2-point gap.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: brazilresearch@eurasiagroup.net .

China—Next leadership cycle will harden centralization around Xi

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EG assesses a 95% likelihood that the 21st Party Congress in late 2027 will grant Xi a fourth term as the general secretary of the Chinese Communist Party and leader of the military, with a pro forma confirmation in early 2028 extending his tenure as president.

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There is no credible opposition to Xi, no sign he intends to relinquish any of his three core roles, and no evidence to support speculation that he is facing significant health issues.

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The lack of succession planning heading into the Party Congress is a strategic choice, and expected personnel changes in 2027 are likely to reaffirm Xi-centered governance.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: china@eurasiagroup.net .

China—Beijing prioritizes productive relations with developed world

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On our recent client trip to China, EG found that, in contrast to a year prior, officials across ministries and the Chinese Communist Party stressed the importance of productive ties with the US, Canada, and the EU, conveying caution about "burning bridges" in a world made more unstable by Middle East conflict and the advance of AI.

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Chinese officials were notably upbeat about the four meetings between presidents Donald Trump and Xi planned for 2026, but cited three risks that could undermine the US-China relationship: the Covid-19 liability litigation brought by the state of Missouri, a proposed $14 billion weapons sale to Taiwan, and US sanctions, export controls, and entity lists.

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Policymakers were candid about weak consumer demand in China. They signaled a willingness to scale up stimulus as needed to sustain growth in the 4.5%–5% target range but gave no indication of near-term structural reform.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: china@eurasiagroup.net .

Friday Insights—The AI boom: who funds it, who bears the labor costs?

This week, two papers on AI's macroeconomic toll ask the same question from opposite ends: who funds the boom, and who bears its costs? Punchline: the AI race is as much about who funds the infrastructure and absorbs the labor costs without political fracture as it is about who builds the best models.

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The AI boom may be capital-constrained, not technology-constrained (Saving for the Machines): AI requires enormous, fast-depreciating capital investment. Fernández-Villaverde shows the same automation path yields much higher growth when households save optimally than at today's US saving rate. The binding constraint on how transformative this technological wave will be is not the technology itself, but whether households will save enough to fund it.

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AI is a wage story before it is an unemployment story (The Recent Evolution of AI-Related Labor Demand): the post-GPT-4o spike in AI job-posting mentions was a one-time shift, not a durable signal of new skill demand. Beneath the surface, the most AI-exposed occupations show rising churn, falling real wages for stayers, and fewer hires under 35. The first-order effect is weaker bargaining power for workers, not mass unemployment.

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Reach out to discuss: geoeconomics@eurasiagroup.net .

upcoming conference calls

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23 October 10:00 AM ET—India update. Register here .

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26 October 10:00 PM ET—Southeast Asia update. Register here .

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27 October 9:00 PM ET—MENA crisis update call. Register here .

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28 October 9:30 AM ET—Latin America update. Register here .

eg in brief

Lebanon—IMF package now unlikely before second quarter of 2027: Prolonged political wrangling, challenging economic conditions, delays in finalizing key bank reform legislation, and the potential resumption of full-scale conflict in Lebanon all make an IMF package unlikely before the second quarter of 2027 at the earliest. A successful constitutional challenge to the Bank Restructuring Law by Lebanese President Joseph Aoun will restore the central bank's broad role and potentially reopen disputes with the IMF over independent oversight of the bank restructuring process. Security risks may also hinder the government's economic agenda: Although Hezbollah is badly degraded and will likely avoid involvement in another round of all-out fighting among the US, Israel, and Iran (65% odds), Tehran will still try to shore up its proxy's military capabilities and may draw it into any major escalation (35% odds). Read more here . Reach out to discuss: mena@eurasiagroup.net .

US—Politics Update with Derek Theurer: The US is likely to push ahead to finalize bilateral trade deals—especially with Mexico, Canada, and China — in 2027. A reconciliation bill passing in the "lame duck" session of Congress after the midterms faces long odds given the short time frame and sentiment of members who have already lost their seats in the midterm elections. The debt limit is more likely to be dealt with next year on a bipartisan basis, with Democrats pushing for the reversal of Medicaid cuts, SNAP benefits, and Affordable Care Act premium tax credits as the price of their votes. Read conference call notes here . Reach out to discuss: unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net .

Upcoming events:

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23 October: Events: Brazil presidential runoff debate; Data: US UMich consumer sentiment.
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24 October: Events: Second round of French protests scheduled.
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25 October: Events: Brazil presidential runoff and Serbia holds parliamentary elections.
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26 October: Events: China's Central Committee Plenum begins, through October 29; Central bank decision: Pakistan.
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27 October: Events: Israeli parliamentary elections; Data: South Korea GDP, and US Conference Board consumer confidence; Central bank decision: Chile.
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28 October: Events: UK budget; Data: India and Russia industrial production, and Russia unemployment; Central bank decisions: Canada, New Zealand, Thailand, and US.
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29 October: Events: EU-Canada Summit begins in Montreal, through October 30; Data: US personal income, PCE price index, and GDP; Central bank decisions: Egypt, ECB, and Ukraine.
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30 October: Data: Eurozone GDP and unemployment, Mexico GDP, France, Italy, and Poland CPI, and Japan and South Korea industrial production; Central bank decision: Colombia and Japan.

The EG Daily Brief is compiled by Jens Larsen, Lucy Eve, Babak Minovi, Pietro Guglielmi, Rahul Bhatia, Martina Silva, with the help of Blaise Hanson, Luisa Moreira, and Marianne Moreira.

We love feedback! Send us a note at DailyBrief@eurasiagroup.net .

closing quip

“The government has lost control of everything.” – Le Pen said in the National Assembly on 21 October.

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